



NAVIGATING FOMO

& GETTING
COMFORTABLE
WITH LOSS

by

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THE WALL STREET COACH

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Introduction

FOMO, or fear of missing out, is a common occurrence not only in trading but in life.

It's that feeling that there's something better on the other side of today or this moment.

Believe it or not, this way of thinking isn't all bad.

It's a human survival technique from thousands of years ago. On the positive side, it can help us continue to strive and to take action to make sure we are as safe as can be and can have as many of our needs met as possible.

However, it's easy to get caught up in the FOMO trap and fall into a cycle of feeling like you're constantly waiting for your best life to begin.

If you're living constantly in the future or "what ifs" you're not present to what you currently have or are experiencing right now.

Some people might argue that what they have right now isn't so fantastic. Why not focus on the future instead?

I won't dismiss that. I'm all about intention and creating your future. But it's also important to find peace where you are.

If you're not able to find peace with the here and now, chances are you'll develop an unhealthy habit of always looking forward and never appreciating what you have now.

That's why it's so important to gain self-awareness about what causes FOMO in your life.

If you struggle with FOMO in life, chances are you'll struggle with it in trading.

For traders, FOMO creates adrenaline spikes that can lead to risky behavior. For example, it might feel necessary to get into a trade. If you don't, you could be missing out on the big one!

This misplaced urgency to get on the train can lead to poor decision-making — and potentially big losses.

Ultimately, FOMO is driven by a discomfort with the present moment and how things are. To begin to unravel this complicated web, it's necessary to lean into that discomfort.

In this book, I'll explore the gritty underside of FOMO and what causes it. I'll also guide you through some powerful exercises to begin facing the demons that cause FOMO in your life.

By gaining a better understanding of what's behind the FOMO in your life and trading, you'll be able to contend with it better — it can improve your outlook, your decision-making, and your self-compassion.

Chapter 1: It All Starts With Intention

Ready to gear up, climb the summit, and begin navigating your own personal relationship with FOMO and fear of loss?

Not so fast. There's something you've got to do first.

During a live session I did on this topic, someone joked that I should coach a prominent politician known for lying, scheming, and his bad Twitter behavior.

It was a funny comment — but honestly, joking aside, I don't know if I could coach such an individual. For coaching to work, one needs to be open to being coached.

Without the proper intention, coaching is a waste of anyone's time, money, and energy.

The same goes for this book.

Before you can begin to address FOMO and fear of loss in your life and trading, you must be open to receiving this kind of work.

Are you open to receiving?

The very fact that you're here reading this is a good indication that you're interested in gaining a deeper level of self-understanding.

But are you open to change, open to being coached, and open to developing yourself?

It will not be easy. It requires inner strength and vulnerability to go to these places.

So before you continue, I want you to take a few moments to consider the following...

Do I struggle with FOMO in trading — does it lead to bad decisions and even losses?

Do I want to change my relationship with FOMO and fear of loss?

Am I open to getting very uncomfortable throughout the process?

Am I willing to do the work even if it is difficult?

Take the time to really consider these things, and what you hope to gain. Once you've made an intention to go on this journey, let's continue.

Chapter 2: FOMO and Fear of Loss: It's Not Just About Trading

Be honest. How often do you trade because you're scared of missing out? Or, how often have you stayed in a trade too long because you're scared of losing?

If you haven't struggled with these things, consider yourself lucky — and in the minority.

They're some of the most commonly reported issues for traders at all levels of experience. FOMO and fear of loss remain a constant struggle even for seasoned, longtime traders.

But why are these things so hard to deal with, and why do they plague traders throughout their careers?

Because there's a deeper root to these emotional struggles. And it usually has nothing to do with trading.

So it's not just a matter of cutting off the behavior. That would be like cutting off the top of a weed in your garden. If the roots are there, it will keep growing back.

Instead, you've got to dig deeper, loosen those roots, and gently remove them.

But before we get into the process of digging deeper, let's talk about how FOMO and fear of loss can affect your trading.

What Drags You Down...

How does FOMO adversely affect trading?

That's pretty simple. Any time you have a "have to" mentality, it can — and often does — sabotage your ability to be in the flow.

Consider an Olympic athlete. They're incredibly good at getting into the flow. If they weren't, they'd never be able to perform in front of an audience! They need to become one with the process, whether it's swimming or gymnastic tumbling or running track. They won't always win, but they can always access their process.

To become one with your process as a trader, you've got to remove what's holding you back.

Sticking with the athletic example, consider how swimmers shave before a meet. It's not purely for aesthetic reasons. They want to reduce any potential drag that could slow them down.

What is creating drag in your trading and in your life? To keep it from holding you back, you've got to shave it off — at least, in a figurative sense.

For many traders, a source of drag is being driven by the idea that they must win.

When you're trading with an urgent need to win or be right, it's like trading with a gun to your head. It's distracting. It's incredibly difficult to focus on things like following your own rules or sticking to your trading plan.

To truly be present to what is in front of you, it's necessary to power past the "I must" and see things as they really are.

Of course, that requires abandoning the idea that every trade should be a home run, which means abandoning the idea that you must be right.

Consider this: home runs and grand slams are roughly one in every 1,250. For a ball player to hope to get one every single time would be unreasonable.

As a trader, you'll ratchet your anxiety way up because you're expecting something that is outside of reality!

When you exist in a land of expectations that are not based in reality, your entire disposition, mindset, and ability to cope is compromised.

The more you compromise, the more you ignore these emotions for what they actually are, the worse off you'll be.

Trading is already challenging. You're competing with some of the smartest people in the world. By going into the process with the emotional drag of undealt-with emotions, it's like going into the game with two arms tied behind your back and 40 pounds of weight on your ankles.

That's a lot of baggage that's hindering you and keeping you from accessing all that you know and your better judgment.

It Goes Deeper Than Trading

Earlier, I alluded to the fact that FOMO and fear of loss are not actually brought on by trading. Rather, they're triggered by an emotional reaction inside of you, the person trading.

While they aren't caused by trading, they have a direct impact on your trading. They can control your reactions and decision-making in trades.

The reason why these struggles are so hard to deal with is that they're based on deeply ingrained emotions which will differ from person to person. So to deal with them, you've got to dig deeper.

Maybe you're thinking that the answer is simple — "I'll just trade without emotions."

It's a great idea, and it might just work — if you were a robot.

But you're not. Unless you're prepared to get a lobotomy and remove your emotions, that simplistic approach is not going to work.

Humans are emotional beings. You can't ignore your emotions. If you try to, you'll probably just bottle them up and they'll off-gas in other, usually unhealthy, ways.

Instead, I suggest finding a way to be with these emotions outside of your trading so you can get to a place of neutrality.

Connecting With Your Inner Gremlins

Believe it or not, struggles like FOMO and fear of loss can actually be a blessing in disguise.

They can act as a catalyst for connecting with your inner gremlins. These are the monsters living inside of you that could be holding you back.

Exploring these emotions can give you access to these gremlins ... What you choose to do once you meet them is up to you.

If you're willing to address them directly, take them on one at a time, and look them in the eye, you may find that these gremlins are really not monstrous at all. They're tiny scared creatures casting huge shadows on your life and trading.

Once you shed some light on them and can see that, you may begin to see incredible results.

For many traders, facing these inner gremlins leads not only to better trading results, but the ability to live life with more happiness and equanimity. Who couldn't use that?

Some people go to Mount Everest to meditate. You're on your own version, and it's called trading. Addressing FOMO and fear of loss requires the same

endurance required of mountain climbers. The results may be less tangible, but they're no less impactful on your life.

But like climbing Mount Everest, it requires a lot of hard work...

Chapter 3: Getting Comfortable With Discomfort

Understanding that FOMO and fear of loss go deeper than just trading is an important step in the process of divorcing yourself from their tyrannical influence.

But it's just the beginning.

What FOMO and fear of loss have in common is a necessary ingredient to be comfortable with discomfort.

To begin processing what plays into your FOMO, you've got to get comfortable with the discomfort of the idea that your current reality may not be meeting all of your needs. In fact, you could be bumping into hard-to-feel feelings left and right and not even realizing it.

On a certain level, most people are aware of discomfort around certain triggers. The key is to be willing to be with that discomfort and to be open to recognizing how it impacts our fear of missing out or fear of loss.

So how do you get comfortable with discomfort?

It starts with some emotional endurance training. It's vital to strengthen yourself emotionally. Like any type of strength training, it can take time.

In my experience, nearly no culture advocates or encourages this type of development. So it's no wonder that for many people, it can feel like being a 90-pound weakling trying to bench press for the first time.

I want to emphasize that it may not be quick or easy work. In my years of coaching and personal work, I have noticed time and time again that this is one of the biggest stumbling blocks. However, I've put together some resources that have proven helpful to many traders...

Two Articles That Could Change Your Life

One of my personal biggest teachers has been writer and educator Raphael Cushnir, who leads workshops on healing and happiness.

I can't recommend his book "The One Thing Holding You Back" enough — but to start, I'd like to suggest two articles that offer a CliffsNotes version of his methodology.

I suggest that you take a pause before continuing to check out both of these articles. Both are easily found online by googling the respective titles and the author's name, but I'll briefly summarize each...

“When's Your Ship Coming In?”

Many people live life in a state of waiting for their dreams to begin. But they don't realize that they are actually letting life pass them by in the meantime.

In truth, when people aren't living their dreams, it's often because they are in their own way. Our own emotions can be the roadblock that is preventing us from living the life we want.

In this article, Cushnir explores the idea that by going through the hard-to-feel emotions, we can actually open up energy channels that allow our dreams to come true.

“Two Questions That Could Change Your Life”

Everyone has experienced setbacks. But if we are closed off emotionally, we can become so scarred over time that it's hard to keep moving forward.

In this article, Cushnir reveals the excruciating pain from a personal setback and how it led him to a higher path.

By examining what we are feeling right now and evaluating our relationship with it, we can in essence lean into that pain and hasten our journey through it.

The Body Doesn't Lie

Another thing to know before moving forward? Your body is a vessel for your trauma and emotions.

There's a fantastic book called “Waking the Tiger: Healing Trauma” by Dr. Peter Levine. It's about somatic healing, and reveals how emotions can lodge themselves in our bodies and the importance of releasing them.

To put it in a simple example, picture a gazelle running from a lion. The lion is in full pursuit but the gazelle gets away.

The gazelle is obviously having a physiological response to almost dying. What does it do?

No ... It doesn't head to the nearest bar for a shot of whiskey. That gazelle will go sit in the bushes — for hours if necessary — and tremor and tremble out that chemical response to the chase.

It will do it as long as necessary until it's shaken off all of that emotional residue. Only when it has fully tremored through the process will it return to the herd.

How do humans handle such trauma? You can bet most of us aren't going to a peaceful place to tremor it out. We are going for the shot of whiskey, or going on a shopping spree, or playing video games ... Or trading. We numb what we don't want to be with.

Numbing is understandable. After all, who really wants to be with those hard-to-be-with feelings? Nobody!

But in truth, the only way to truly get out of that pain is to go through it. It's counterintuitive. Who could imagine that letting yourself be with hard to be with feelings could actually set you free?

The fact is, we can't circumvent the pain forever. It's in our body, and it accumulates over time.

Do you really want to be living with all of that residual pain and baggage inside of you?

The concept of learning how to be with what is hard to be with is challenging. But it can also increase your ability to deal with discomfort, loss, and FOMO.

Once you face these gremlins that you're so intent on avoiding, you may find that instead of a monster, as Cushnir puts it, "it ends up being a gerbil in drag." It's probably not as intimidating as you think.

The heart of this work is to build an internal muscle of being with something that inside of you puts you in a contraction, and learning how to be with it.

So how do you get started? Take it slow. Read those articles. Check out the books. It will walk you through how to be with it now, and how to be with it. To continue moving forward, I'll offer a physical exercise to try...

Chapter 4: An Exercise For Facing FOMO and Fear of Loss

Building on the concepts introduced in the last chapter, here's a simple exercise to add to your routine.

It's a simple exercise, but don't be fooled by that. It can be an extremely challenging and profound exercise if you really put yourself into the process.

It's also not meant to be a one-time deal. This is meant to be an ongoing process that allows you to explore your deeper emotions. It might be something that you do daily or weekly to continue digging deeper.

A Simple Exercise For Facing FOMO and Fear of Loss

First, situate yourself somewhere comfortable without distractions.

Next, close your eyes. This is an important step — closing your eyes can help you take the elevator down from your head into your body.

Since many of us don't have a strong mind-body connection, this part alone can be difficult. But our bodies are packed with so much information that we so infrequently access. Simply closing your eyes can help us tap into what is going on beyond our intellect.

Next, call to mind the last time you were feeling really uncomfortable or really triggered.

This might be trading-related, but it might not. Maybe it was a big loss. Maybe it was feeling FOMO. Maybe it was comparing yourself to someone else. Or maybe it was knowing that you had a bill coming due soon or that taxes were coming up soon. I know I have a contraction when I have to send out those big checks!

As you access this uncomfortable memory, turn inward. See if you can identify where in your physical body there is a sensation — a contraction or tightness or some sort of unpleasant reaction. See if you can tap into the location and put your hand there to help you connect even deeper.

Now, sit with this sensation and simply observe.

Your intellect might be kicking in and saying "This is ridiculous, this is a waste of time, why am I doing this. Am I doing it right?"

It's fine to notice these thoughts. But try to notice them as if they're clouds in the sky — you see them, but they're just moving by. If they're really tricky, loud thoughts, you may choose to acknowledge them and say “thank you for your input” and dismiss them.

Continue to pay attention. Notice if the mental or physical sensations begin to change. They may begin to get lower in volume or get higher. The sensation might shift to a different region of your body. It could be that new emotions are coming forward for you.

Do what you need to do to take a snapshot of this experience in your mind's eye. When you're ready, come back to the current moment. Open your eyes.

Examining the Experience

Now that you're back from this experience ... How did it go?

If it feels challenging or even impossible to go through with the exercise, it's OK. It's an unfamiliar practice, and it might feel intimidating.

Often, people will find a lot of discomfort in this exercise, but they will be affected by it.

There's no right or wrong to how you feel or how you react or feel afterward. However, since this is a new practice, it may be helpful to have some input from how others have gone through it. Here are two examples of people who I have guided through the process:

Sample Reactions

One person going through this exercise reported having a very affecting experience. It was easy to access the memory because it had been recent.

He felt intense tightness all around his throat. When he put his attention on it, it loosened and relaxed and moved into his chest.

For him, the emotional content was very clear. It started as anger, and gradually faded into sadness.

It's amazing that he was able to see that shift — that's the power of being present to one's body. It gives us time and space to let these emotions move through. It's not unusual to see the emotions shift to deeper levels — sometimes

they even go through multiple iterations. Ultimately, if you go deep enough, you come to the beating heart of what is behind the discomfort.

For another person, entering this experience led her to feel like she was in a crowded room with loud noises. It felt like full sensory overload.

When she went inside of her body, the noise got lower and lower. It felt good like she was in more control of her emotions and it felt more calm.

She was able to understand how she was feeling and see what was inside of her. She believed that the longer she did it the more calm she would feel.

For her, this was an amazing feeling because that noise gave her anxiety and couldn't focus. Yet as she went inward, the voices calmed down, and the pressure she felt in her head and chest began to recede to her throat and chest.

What's Happening Now? Can I Be With It?

Ultimately, this exercise boils down to the two questions Cushnir suggests people ask themselves during uncomfortable times:

What's happening now?
Can I be with it?

The answer to the second might be "hell no" — but there's value in even that.

It tells you that you're facing a very big thing.

If that's your reaction, be gentle with yourself. Some people may only be able to access powerful emotions to go into that moment for a very short time. That's OK.

If being with it is hard that is OK and if you need to come out it is OK. If you can only do this practice for 30 seconds this time, it's fine. To try to stay a little longer every time. Don't overwhelm your system. But do challenge yourself. You want to push the edges of the envelope every time.

I advocate practicing this daily — or at least multiple times a week.

As you practice and develop these muscles you're retraining your brain to be able to unhook itself from the ego. That is when you'll hear the real messages rather than the ones that tell you "that was the one and you missed it" or "I can't take a loss because to take a loss means something about me personally."

The thing is ... Loss is part of being a trader. Loss is part of being a human. How many times have we been encouraged to find a way to make ourselves not wrong for bumping into discomfort?

We feel bad when we make mistakes. I am not an advocate of losing or that we should just stop trying because mistakes are inevitable.

But if we are constantly triggered significantly by the loss, then we have to realize that aversion is costing us. The key is to come into neutrality.

Getting Into Neutrality

What does it actually mean to get into a state of neutrality?

I call it emotional non-resistance. My mentor Cushnir refers to it as emotional connection. Either way, it's about learning how to be with the hard-to-be-with stuff.

Why must we learn how to be with this uncomfortable stuff?

Because ultimately, FOMO is a fear of feeling the discomfort of missing out. Fear of loss is the fear of feeling the bad feelings that come with losing.

The goal of the exercise I introduced in the last chapter is to help you get comfortable with hard-to-be-with feelings.

If you were to regularly practice this exercise, it could potentially get you very in tune with what is driving the emotions that are directly affecting your trading.

You could think of it as a daily defragging of the system. It's a palate cleanser so you can go into your trading day neutral.

Wouldn't it be nice to go into your trading day free of all that baggage?

Addressing and facing these things could help you move them to the side when it's time to trade. That means they won't be affecting your every trading decision. It could be hugely impactful on your overall results.

But remember: it's not a one-and-done sort of deal. This is a practice. To put it in perspective, I've been doing this practice for 14 years and have no intentions of quitting any time soon.

It's ongoing. You can keep going deeper and cultivating this practice to get into the heart of what is underneath.

Think back to the example earlier where someone doing this exercise saw the initial emotion of anger spiral its way into sadness. These emotions need space to breathe so that they can process and move on.

Remember: emotions live in the body. If you don't let an emotion process, chances are it could still be lurking inside of you. When you consider every emotion you've ever felt throughout your life, that adds up to a lot of residue over the years.

To me, that's a huge motivator to be with the hard-to-be-with feelings. I don't want them living dormant in my body!

They will out themselves one way or another. I'd prefer that it not be unhealthy or potentially destructive. For me, this practice is like a steam vent. It helps create a release valve of all of the gunky stuff I don't want affecting how I conduct myself in the world.

Chapter 5: Trading Case Studies

To begin to bring these lessons home, I'd like to share two examples of traders who I guided through this exercise and practice via a coaching session.

In these sessions, they are directly facing their dragons. Their stories may be different than your own, but they're extremely relatable and parts of their struggles may ring true.

Case Study 1: Samantha: FOMO and Throwing Out the Rules

Coming into the session, Samantha's desire was to gain the tools to control her emotions when it comes to the topic of losing money.

This was a very big issue for her. As a relatively new trader, she found that she'd made a good amount in the beginning — but then she started chasing and lost just about everything.

She already knew FOMO was the culprit. She had this big fear of missing a potential spike. But more often than not, she found herself bag-holding after an irrational chase.

FOMO was definitely holding her back. She wanted to be able to stop, think about it, and master thinking critically about a potential trade rather than getting lost in the idea that she had to get in right then.

Breaking the Rules

At that point, I asked her if she had defined criteria for trades.

Indeed she did. She'd pursued an education and knew what she should be looking for. But her emotions would take over and override because of the siren call of missing out or making a quick buck or two.

She knew the rules, but she was breaking them because her emotions were getting in the way. This made the self-punishment cycle even worse, because she knew what she should be doing.

She knew that her criteria was there to protect her from these potholes in the market.

What's the Trigger?

With Samantha, the next step was to begin looking at the specific chain of events or emotional triggers that make her not follow her own rules.

At what point did she deviate from the road she knew she should stay on? What was informing her not following the criteria?

It's easy to see that it's driven by emotion. But what is the void she's trying to fill?

According to Samantha, she wanted to "hop on the train before it leaves." That led to a series of rapid-fire questions...

What happens if she doesn't jump on the train? *I missed it.*

What then? *I'd be sad that I missed out.*

What's hard about missing out? *Regret.*

What would it be that she'd be saying as she's left behind? *I could have made money. I could have done that. I could have been that much richer. I could have gained that much more.*

Is that something she has a tendency to do outside of trading? Yes.

When did it begin? *Probably when I was young. I'm very competitive, so if I see someone do something, I want to do it too and succeed. I want to be good — no, great at it. I don't want to be sitting there in the corner watching.*

Who is that person who sits in the corner? *That person is antisocial. That person is going to miss out on the fun of the activity, of not being involved. They're going to miss out on being rich.*

The last question I pose to you, reader: do you think it's possible this voice — telling her that being the person in the corner, missing out, is the worst place to be — is not authentic or rational but is actually some sort of a gremlin or inner dragon?

What kinds of stories is your inner gremlin telling you?

Samantha's Homework

Following that session, I gave Samantha a homework assignment.

For one week, I challenged her to be that person in the corner. To be the person who “misses out” in small ways. It didn’t have to be huge — it might be holding back on a trade she wasn’t sure about or skipping out on a party she was on the fence about attending.

I urged her to pretend she was a famous actress taking on the role of the girl who’s in the corner missing out. Could she observe what the story was, how triggered the gremlin becomes?

Why go through this assignment? I wanted that story to play out and for her to see what it really might feel like to miss out. I wasn’t convinced the story her gremlin was telling her was actually true.

Take a cue from Samantha’s homework. If part of her story resonated with you, challenge yourself to go to that “worst-case” scenario and face your gremlin.

Challenges like this are not fun. But they are necessary due diligence if you want to get to the bottom of what is holding you back as a trader.

If you have a farm or garden, you have to till the soil. Otherwise it will carry residue of what was last planted there and it could affect new growth. It’s not a fun process. It’s yucky and tedious. Yet it’s necessary.

It’s the same with this inner work. It’s simple — but not easy.

You want to get underneath what this gremlin is about, the hard-to-be with feeling of missing out and face that discomfort so that you can divorce yourself from it.

Your trading won’t be the only thing to shift. Your life will shift too.

Case Study 2: Carl: Overcoming the PDT Rule Scarcity Mindset

Carl, who had become an accomplished paper trader, wanted to be able to apply what he’d learned to his actual money account.

He’d noticed that in the beginning, he experienced FOMO with his large paper trading account. He’d never traded before and got caught up in following traders and trying to replicate their picks. It actually — he was in the green, and that felt good.

But early on he realized it was not a sustainable strategy. Following another trader is not reliable in the long-term. There are too many variables involved

. He realized that he was actually more motivated by fear than making quick reactions.

Over time, with observation, that fear-based strategy began to dwindle. He got good at observing the impulse to follow and being able to intellectualize the strategy and to focus on trading the chart action rather than emotion.

This helped him reduce his reliance on following pro traders and his fear of missing out.

But in facing upgrading to real money after paper trading, he found that it was a whole new ball game.

However, being under the PDT creates an intensity to make every trade count.

Because he can only execute a finite number of trades per week, if one goes against him it's a massive hit because he knows his opportunities for the next few days are closing in.

He really wants to be right about it, and it can make him stay in trades for too long or make mistakes. It can kick in just long enough to break the stop loss.

It was keeping him from following his own criteria.

What's Behind It?

The concept of needing to be right is often driven by the ego. It tells us the story that we are only worthy if we are right.

Trading is inherently at odds with the ego's message. In the land of trading, you're going to be wrong 50 percent of the time — if you're lucky.

So how do we get comfortable with being wrong?

It starts with getting curious about what being wrong actually means.

In his paper account, Carl was OK with loss. He wasn't losing time and energy over it.

But in the cash account, it was totally different. He said "With the cash account, the story is I've only got three day trades in five days so if I'm wrong that's one less trade and I'm screwing myself and so on and so on..."

While he went through this inner cycle, trades got further and further away from him.

He was using a different methodology with cash than paper trading. So how could he progress back to cash without getting stuck on this?

When I dug deeper, it became clear that the expectation of a grand slam has repeated over and over in Carl's life — starting a successful business, having the perfect marriage, and so on. He's observed it has been part of a sabotage mechanism that has neutralized his objectives. His trouble with trading follows that pattern.

It's like Carl goes into every endeavor with a ruler, and it affects how he shows up. The problem is that you can't measure with a made-up ruler. You can't use it to measure yourself.

That ruler is actually manufactured by your internal gremlin. That gremlin is measuring you with a cartoon-scale ruler, so naturally you're feeling like you fall short of that expectation.

That pressure, that weight — they have a cost on your life, and your trading.

Carl's Homework

For Carl, my homework assignment had two parts.

First, I wanted him to get curious about the ruler with which he was measuring himself.

I wanted him to ask and answer himself honestly: Is it mine? Is it my gremlin's?

For instance, if he was comparing his trading performance to pro traders and measuring himself against their performance, that's not fair. Compare = despair!

The second part of his homework involved a plan for re-entering trading while retaining some of the same aptitude he'd put toward paper trading.

He already had the aptitude. But he wasn't following his own rules in his cash account because of FOMO.

So the shift needed to be in his mindset and his relationship to the PDT rule.

I urged him to ask himself this question to help shift his perspective:

What if those three trades were actually great and an opportunity to protect yourself?

You might lose those three trades for weeks at a time. But there will be that one week, one day, where you follow your criteria and it does work out.

This is not about winning every day. Or every trade. It's about following your criteria and rules and being thrilled when you do win.

In short, I wanted Carl to remember that it's about singles — not home runs.

How often does a home run happen in baseball? Not often. If you look for that every time you trade, your expectations are beyond what would be appropriate to expect from yourself. You will always fall short.

It's about small achievements.

Chapter 6: Putting It To Work: Facing Your Gremlins

Facing what plays into your personal FOMO and fear of loss is a highly personal process.

The case studies may have given you some ideas about where you need to go.

But where do you take it from here?

The good news, as you've seen, is that it is not a complicated process. It's really just about being with your feelings.

Of course, as you've seen in the case studies, this process can get more and more complicated as you dig into the emotions that are underneath what causes your FOMO and fear of loss.

In the past books in this series, we've talked about greed, fear of failure, and other trading-related fears and emotions.

Like in the other books, the solution begins with curiosity.

How could you get curious about your own tendencies, observe them, be with them, and learn to live with them?

As my mentor Cushnir says, "Resistance is like stepping on a hose with all our might and commanding the water to flow."

Unfortunately, to actually let the water flow, we must face what is uncomfortable to be with.

It's worth it. Once you do change your relationship with the gremlins to turn around and face them and recognize that they are not so powerful at all, it might change more than just your trading. It could change your entire life.

Did you enjoy this ebook? If so consider the rest of Kim Ann Curtin's ebook series:

Book 1: Ego and Inner Gremlins: How Your Emotions Impact Your Trading

Are you being driven by ego and inner gremlins without even realizing it? For many traders, these monsters of self-sabotage can cause poor decision-making and impulse control. In this book, traders will gain a better understanding of what drives these inner critics so that they can begin to free themselves of destructive inner chatter that may be holding them back.

Book 2: Deconstructing Greed and Fear of Failure

Fear of failure and greed can lead to taking foolish risks and the erosion of both one's trading account and mental capital. That can lead to a toxic cycle of negative self-talk and reduced self-esteem and self-worth. But did you know that fear of failure and greed are usually symptoms of deeper underlying issues? This book helps traders get to the bottom of these issues in a way that can actually bring about positive change in their trading.

Book 4: Discipline and Finding Your Edge

Struggles with discipline and a lack of proven edge are struggles that both new traders and seasoned traders with decades-long careers face. In this book, traders will get insight into why these common struggles persist for so long and learn powerful tools for identifying and working with their own tendencies to gain greater control in their trading and lives.

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